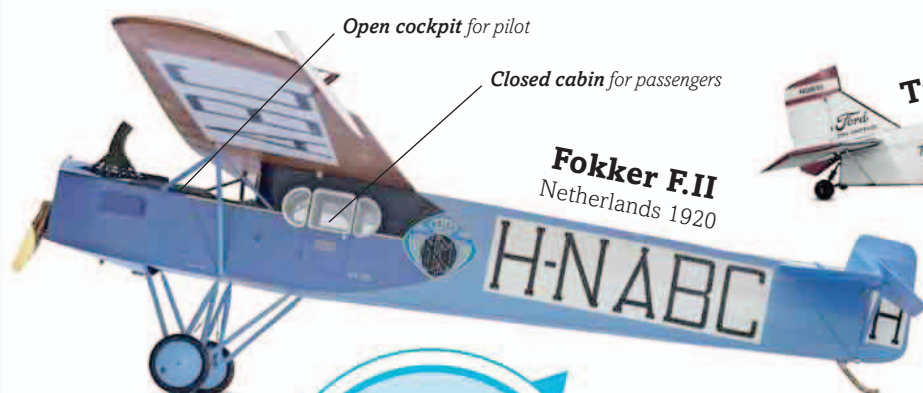




Plane spotting



Open cockpit for pilot

Closed cabin for passengers

Fokker F.II
Netherlands 1920



Ford 5-AT Trimotor
USA 1928

Body panels made of corrugated (ridged) aluminum

Plywood body keeps weight down to 3,219lb (1,460kg) when empty

F.IIs were flown by **KLM**, the world's **oldest airline** still flying under its original name.



Douglas DC-2
USA 1934



de Havilland DH89 Dragon Rapide
UK 1934

Giant wings have span of 262ft (80m)

Undercarriage folds up into the aircraft to cut drag when flying



Sud-Aviation Caravelle
France 1955

Rear-mounted turbojet engine gives top speed of 500 mph (805 km/h)



de Havilland DH106 Comet 4C
UK 1960

Tailplanes contain elevator panels to help the plane climb or descend

Early passenger planes were converted bombers and other military aircraft. Planes specially built for air travel truly arrived in the 1920s and 1930s. Today, flying has become a fast, convenient, and common form of transportation.

The **Fokker F.II** carried just four passengers, while the **Ford 5-AT Trimotor** could hold 13, plus two crew members. The **Douglas DC-2** could carry one passenger more and was flown by more than 30 airlines all around the world, as was the simple but rugged **de Havilland DH89**